

Santiago Cantillo-Cleves¹

Email: santiago@ucsd.edu

Webpage: TBD

Research Areas

Political Economy, Applied Micro, Development, Spatial Economics

Academic Advisors

[Sam Bazzi](#), [Treb Allen](#), [David Atkin](#), [Carlos Hernández](#)

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of California at San Diego, *current*

Graduate visiting student, MIT, 2020

M.A. in Economics, Universidad de los Andes, 2020. *Honored thesis: Consumption Enhancing Roads.*

B.A. in Government & Public Affairs, Universidad de los Andes, 2018

B.A. in Economics, Universidad de los Andes, 2017

Minor in Public Law, Universidad de los Andes, 2017

Published and Forthcoming Papers

“The Traveling Trucker Problem” with [Treb Allen](#), [David Atkin](#) & [Carlos Hernández](#). *American Economic Association, Papers and Proceedings*, Vol. 114, 2024. ([link](#))

“A Toolkit for Setting and Evaluating Price Floors” with Carlos Eduardo Hernández. *Journal of Public Economics*, Vol. 232, 2024. ([link](#))

Work in Progress

“Trucks” with [Treb Allen](#), [David Atkin](#) & [Carlos Hernández](#)

“The Where and Why of Campaign Rallies: Evidence from the 2018 Mexican Presidential Election” with [Jaakko Meriläinen](#)

¹ *Cantillo* is my father’s last name, *Cleves* is my mother’s last name. I’ve hyphenated both.

Fellowships, Grants and Awards

2024-2025	UC Alianza MX–Short-Term Research in Mexico for UC Graduate Students
2021–2022	Regents Fellowship, UCSD

Conferences

2022	SOCAL
2019	ASSA/AEA

Referee for Research Articles

Journal of Development Economics

Consulting

Regulation, Infrastructure, and Transportation Consultant for “Global Transport Flagship Report: Shrinking Economic Distance.” Funder: World Bank. 2021-2023 ([link](#))

- Estimated the impact of road freight regulations and road infrastructure investments on transportation costs.
- Modeled trade flows and freight rates using microdata on roads, freight rates, truck ownership, and truck trips.
- Employed structural econometrics, reduced-form causal analysis, and GIS applications.

Programming

Stata (Advanced); MATLAB (Intermediate); Python, R, GIS, Excel (Basic)

Languages

Spanish (Native); English (Advanced); French (Intermediate); Italian (Basic)

Additional activities

2020	Fundraiser & volunteer, “Fundación Hermanos sin Condiciones”, Colombia Helped the foundation raise money and organize the construction of a water
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well in a desertic Colombian region where 120 families lacked access to water.

- 2013 Mentor, “Fundación Con Las Manos”, Volunteer service, Colombia
Math teacher for primary level students from poor backgrounds.
- 2009-2012 Local coordinator, “Soñar Despierto”, Colombia
Coordinated fundraising and development of local libraries, community restaurants and activities for families from poor backgrounds.